

Cold Email Templates for IIT Professors – Research Internship

For a 3rd year B.Tech Computer Science student seeking a summer research internship.

Template 1: Machine Learning / AI Research

Subject: Research Internship Inquiry – Summer 2026 | B.Tech CS Student

Dear Professor [Name],

I hope this email finds you well. My name is [Your Name], and I am a 3rd year B.Tech Computer Science student at [Your College]. I am writing to express my interest in pursuing a summer research internship under your guidance at [IIT Name].

I have been following your work on [specific paper/project – e.g., "efficient fine-tuning of large language models" or "robust visual representation learning"], and I find it deeply compelling. Your recent paper on [specific topic] particularly resonated with my interests in [ML/deep learning/NLP/computer vision].

Over the past two years, I have built a strong foundation in machine learning and deep learning through coursework and projects:

- [Project 1 – e.g., "Built a transformer-based text summarization model achieving X ROUGE score"]
- [Project 2 – e.g., "Implemented and benchmarked various GAN architectures for image synthesis"]
- [Relevant coursework or competition – e.g., "Ranked top X% in Kaggle competition on Y"]

I am proficient in Python, PyTorch, and TensorFlow, and have experience with [relevant tools/frameworks].

I would be honored to contribute to your research group this summer (May–July 2026). I am happy to work on any ongoing projects where my skills could be useful, and I am eager to learn new techniques and methodologies under your mentorship.

I have attached my CV for your reference. I would be grateful if you could consider my application, and I am happy to discuss my background further at your convenience.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Warm regards,

[Your Name]

[Your College], B.Tech CSE (3rd Year)

[Email] | [Phone] | [LinkedIn/GitHub]

Template 2: Systems / Architecture / OS Research

Subject: Summer Research Internship – Systems Research | B.Tech CS, 3rd Year

Dear Professor [Name],

I am [Your Name], a 3rd year B.Tech Computer Science student at [Your College], writing to inquire about the possibility of a summer research internship in your lab at [IIT Name].

I have a strong interest in systems research, particularly in [operating systems / distributed systems / computer architecture / compiler design – pick relevant area]. Your work on [specific project/paper – e.g., "scalable consensus protocols" or "memory-safe OS kernels"] caught my attention, and I am keen to explore this area further under your guidance.

My relevant experience includes:

- [Project 1 – e.g., "Designed a multi-threaded key-value store with consistent hashing"]
- [Project 2 – e.g., "Implemented a toy operating system kernel with virtual memory and process scheduling"]
- [Skills – e.g., "Strong proficiency in C/C++, experience with Linux kernel internals, familiarity with RISC-V architecture"]

I enjoy working at the intersection of theory and implementation, and I thrive on building systems from scratch to understand them deeply.

I would love the opportunity to contribute to your ongoing research this summer (May–July 2026). I have attached my CV and would be happy to share code samples or discuss my work in more detail.

Thank you for considering my request. I look forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,

[Your Name]

[Your College], B.Tech CSE (3rd Year)

[Email] | [Phone] | [LinkedIn/GitHub]

Template 3: Security / Cryptography / Privacy Research

Subject: Research Internship Interest – Cybersecurity/Cryptography | Summer 2026

Dear Professor [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am [Your Name], a 3rd year B.Tech Computer Science student at [Your College]. I am reaching out to express my keen interest in a summer research internship in your lab at [IIT Name], particularly in the area of [cybersecurity / cryptography / privacy-preserving computation].

Your research on [specific topic – e.g., "post-quantum cryptographic protocols" or "differential privacy in machine learning" or "binary analysis and vulnerability detection"] is an area I find both intellectually stimulating and practically important. I have been exploring related topics through:

- [Project/Experience 1 – e.g., "Participated in CTF competitions (top X in Y CTF), focusing on binary exploitation and reverse engineering"]
- [Project/Experience 2 – e.g., "Implemented AES and RSA from scratch; studied side-channel attack vectors"]
- [Coursework – e.g., "Completed advanced courses in network security and applied cryptography"]

I am comfortable with [C/C++, Python, assembly, tools like Ghidra/IDA/Wireshark – as applicable], and I am eager to deepen my understanding through hands-on research.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to work with your group this summer (May–July 2026). I have attached my CV for your review and would welcome the chance to discuss how I might contribute to your research.

Thank you for your time, and I hope to hear from you soon.

Sincerely,

[Your Name]

[Your College], B.Tech CSE (3rd Year)

[Email] | [Phone] | [LinkedIn/GitHub]

□ **Tips for Cold Emailing Professors**

1. **Be specific:** Reference a particular paper or project. Generic emails get ignored.
2. **Keep it concise:** Professors are busy. 200-300 words max.
3. **Show competence:** Mention concrete projects, not just coursework names.
4. **Attach CV as PDF:** Name it `YourName_CV.pdf` .
5. **Follow up once:** If no reply in 10-14 days, send one polite follow-up.
6. **Apply broadly:** Email 15-25 professors across different IITs.
7. **Timing:** Send emails in Feb-March for summer positions.
8. **Subject line matters:** Include "Research Internship" + your year + area of interest.
9. **Find professors:** Check IIT department pages, Google Scholar, DBLP for active researchers.
10. **Don't mass-blast:** Personalize each email. Professors can tell when you haven't read their work.